

Made in India

One out of every five cell phones sold in India are from Indian brands such as Micromax and Spice. Mediatek from Taiwan provides the chipsets for most of these. Check out our comparison test of affordable mobile phones on page 84

Crack the Code

Crack the Code contest winners announced on page 116. The solutions are at www.thinkdigit.com/ctc, for those of you who couldn't crack our code

Speedy Opera(tor)!

Opera Mini 5 Beta 2 finally makes it on to cellular platforms the world over

Opera's mobile browser is quite popular with over 30-million people worldwide using it. It recently came out with the Opera Mini 5 beta 2, the latest version for mobile platforms. The user interface has been revamped from Mini 4.2. It claims to give you a similar web experience as your desktop PC. We tried it out and can assure you that this claim is not 100 per cent true.

Opera Mini 5 is a 263 kilobyte file which can be downloaded from <http://www.opera.com/mobile/>. The installation is a piece of cake.

The UI is neatly compartmentalised into various sections like Navigation bar, Address bar, Speed Dial page, Search field. The Navigation bar encloses a tabs button which allows you to have multiple tabs as on a PC. Even the Speed dial page can become a tab. The Tab option makes Internet surfing quite rich.

For Opera browser users, the familiar Speed Dial menu is

a logical addition. It also allows you to synchronise your bookmarks, speed dial settings with the help of Opera Link.

Another addition is the long hold click. This opens up a set of options whenever you hold onto a spot on the page. For instance while reading an article if you click down for some time on a particular word, the browser will open options like Select Text, Copy and Search is just like a right click would be, on a desktop PC. The same goes with links in web pages. Long hold allows you the option to open the link in a new tab.

The Mini 5 works on both non-touch as well as touch-screen phones. We tried it out on a touchscreen phone and the experience was quite something. Features like tabbed browsing and long hold click were very intuitive and it does bring some aspect of browsing on a desktop PC or laptop on the cellular platform. But we found the zoom experience a bit off the mark. Opera Mini 5



Opera Mini 5 Beta 2 on touch-based handsets



This is how Opera Mini 5 looks on non-touch-based devices

has an option to view the full web page, that allows you to select the portion of the page you are interested in reading by double-clicking on it.

While using the Opera Mini 5 on a non-touch phone, we felt that the user experience is not very different. The alignment of menus is slightly tweaked for non-touch phones. For instance the Tab screen has been shifted to the top of the browser screen and the Settings menu becomes a drop-down menu.

When a web page is requested while using Opera Mini 5, the request is sent to a server farm which sends it to a proxy server. This server

renders and reformats the page and converts it into a light and efficient format developed by Opera called the Opera Binary Markup Language. This rendered page is then sent to the client phone. Now since most of these complex operations happen at the server side, it allows the Opera Mini 5 to be used on relatively low-specification phones. The settings menu allows you to bookmark pages, save pages, download and perform other functions in a similar manner as you would do it on the desktop.

Opera has announced it is submitting its Opera Mini browser to Apple for use on the